- The tail – end (Posterior end) of the male worm is curved ventrally to form a hook and 2 curved copulatory spicules.

**Female worm**

- The adult female worm is larger (20–40 cm) and thicker (3–6 mm) than male worm.
- The posterior end is conical and straight. The anus is in the sub terminal part and opens like a transverse slit on the ventral surface.
- The vulva is situated mid – ventrally, near the junction of the anterior and middle thirds of the body. This part of the worm is narrow and is called the vulvar waist.
- A single worm lays up to 200,000 eggs per day.

**Egg:** Two types of eggs are passed in feces by the worms.

**Fertilized Egg**

- The fertilized eggs are produced by fertilized females.
- The eggs are round or oval in shape and measures 45 µm in length and 35µm to 50µm in breadth.
- They are bile – stained and appear as golden brown (brownish) in colour.
- The egg is surrounded by a thick smooth shell with an outer albuminous coat (corticated eggs). Sometimes this outer coat is lost in few eggs. Those eggs are called as decorticated eggs (Figure 8.16).
- Each egg contains a large unsegmented ovum with a clear crescentic area at each pole. The eggs float in saturated solution of common salt.

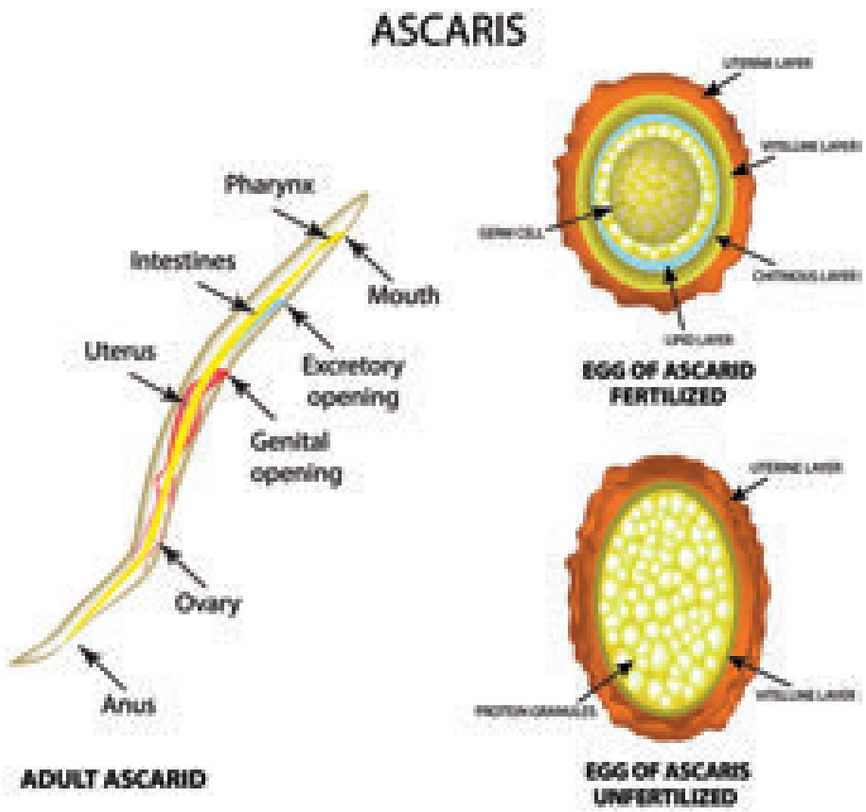



**Figure 8.16:** Fertilized and Unfertilized egg of *Ascaris lumbricoides*



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